

The second integral defines an entire function, while

$$\int_0^1 \frac{x^{s-1}}{e^x - 1} dx = \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} \frac{B_m}{m!(s+m-1)},$$

where B_m denotes the m^{th} Bernoulli number defined by

$$\frac{x}{e^x - 1} = \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} \frac{B_m}{m!} x^m.$$

Then $B_0 = 1$, and since $z/(e^z - 1)$ is holomorphic for $|z| < 2\pi$, we must have $\limsup_{m \rightarrow \infty} |B_m/m!|^{1/m} = 1/2\pi$.]

17. Let f be an indefinitely differentiable function on $\mathbb{R}$ that has compact support, or more generally, let f belong to the Schwartz space.⁴ Consider

$$I(s) = \frac{1}{\Gamma(s)} \int_0^{\infty} f(x) x^{-1+s} dx.$$

- (a) Observe that $I(s)$ is holomorphic for $\operatorname{Re}(s) > 0$. Prove that I has an analytic continuation as an entire function in the complex plane.
- (b) Prove that $I(0) = 0$, and more generally

$$I(-n) = (-1)^n f^{(n+1)}(0) \quad \text{for all } n \geq 0.$$

[Hint: To prove the analytic continuation, as well as the formulas in the second part, integrate by parts to show that $I(s) = \frac{(-1)^k}{\Gamma(s+k)} \int_0^{\infty} f^{(k)}(x) x^{s+k-1} dx$.]

4 Problems

1. This problem provides further estimates for ζ and ζ' near $\operatorname{Re}(s) = 1$.

- (a) Use Proposition 2.5 and its corollary to prove

$$\zeta(s) = \sum_{1 \leq n < N} n^{-s} - \frac{N^{s-1}}{s-1} + \sum_{n \geq N} \delta_n(s)$$

for every integer $N \geq 2$, whenever $\operatorname{Re}(s) > 0$.

- (b) Show that $|\zeta(1+it)| = O(\log |t|)$, as $|t| \rightarrow \infty$ by using the previous result with $N = \text{greatest integer in } |t|$.

⁴The Schwartz space on $\mathbb{R}$ is denoted by $\mathcal{S}$ and consists of all indefinitely differentiable functions f , so that f and all its derivatives decay faster than any polynomials. In other words, $\sup_{x \in \mathbb{R}} |x|^m |f^{(\ell)}(x)| < \infty$ for all integers $m, \ell \geq 0$. This space appeared in the study of the Fourier transform in Book I.

- (c) The second conclusion of Proposition 2.7 can be similarly refined.
- (d) Show that if $t \neq 0$ and t is fixed, then the partial sums of the series $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} 1/n^{1+it}$ are bounded, but the series does not converge.

2.* Prove that for $\operatorname{Re}(s) > 0$

$$\zeta(s) = \frac{s}{s-1} - s \int_1^{\infty} \frac{\{x\}}{x^{s+1}} dx$$

where $\{x\}$ is the fractional part of x .

3.* If $Q(x) = \{x\} - 1/2$, then we can write the expression in the previous problem as

$$\zeta(s) = \frac{s}{s-1} - \frac{1}{2} - s \int_1^{\infty} \frac{Q(x)}{x^{s+1}} dx.$$

Let us construct $Q_k(x)$ recursively so that

$$\int_0^1 Q_k(x) dx = 0, \quad \frac{dQ_{k+1}}{dx} = Q_k(x), \quad Q_0(x) = Q(x) \quad \text{and} \quad Q_k(x+1) = Q_k(x).$$

Then we can write

$$\zeta(s) = \frac{s}{s-1} - \frac{1}{2} - s \int_1^{\infty} \left(\frac{d^k}{dx^k} Q_k(x) \right) x^{-s-1} dx,$$

and a k -fold integration by parts gives the analytic continuation for $\zeta(s)$ when $\operatorname{Re}(s) > -k$.

4.* The functions Q_k in the previous problem are related to the Bernoulli polynomials $B_k(x)$ by the formula

$$Q_k(x) = \frac{B_{k+1}(x)}{(k+1)!} \quad \text{for } 0 \leq x \leq 1.$$

Also, if k is a positive integer, then

$$2\zeta(2k) = (-1)^{k+1} \frac{(2\pi)^{2k}}{(2k)!} B_{2k},$$

where $B_k = B_k(0)$ are the Bernoulli numbers. For the definition of $B_k(x)$ and B_k see Chapter 3 in Book I.

7 The Zeta Function and Prime Number Theorem

Bernhard Riemann, whose extraordinary intuitive powers we have already mentioned, has especially renovated our knowledge of the distribution of prime numbers, also one of the most mysterious questions in mathematics. He has taught us to deduce results in that line from considerations borrowed from the integral calculus: more precisely, from the study of a certain quantity, a function of a variable s which may assume not only real, but also imaginary values. He proved some important properties of that function, but enunciated two or three as important ones without giving the proof. At the death of Riemann, a note was found among his papers, saying “These properties of $\zeta(s)$ (the function in question) are deduced from an expression of it which, however, I did not succeed in simplifying enough to publish it.”

We still have not the slightest idea of what the expression could be. As to the properties he simply enunciated, some thirty years elapsed before I was able to prove all of them but one. The question concerning that last one remains unsolved as yet, though, by an immense labor pursued throughout this last half century, some highly interesting discoveries in that direction have been achieved. It seems more and more probable, but still not at all certain, that the “Riemann hypothesis” is true.

J. Hadamard, 1945

Euler found, through his product formula for the zeta function, a deep connection between analytical methods and arithmetic properties of numbers, in particular primes. An easy consequence of Euler’s formula is that the sum of the reciprocals of all primes, $\sum_p 1/p$, diverges, a result that quantifies the fact that there are infinitely many prime numbers. The natural problem then becomes that of understanding how these primes are distributed. With this in mind, we consider the